THE UNIVERSITY OF MELBOURNE

ASSESSING

ACTING ETHICALLY

NEW METRICS: 2025

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WITH MANY THANKS TO
schools, industry and credentialing research-practice partners, whose contributions continue to combine with the broader work of the University of Melbourne to inform the development of this work.

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Assessment of Complex Competencies: A Poem

Assessment is
a **process**
of gathering evidence
from a **variety** of contexts
in which the learner can show what they are **capable** of
in a **complex** domain of learning
to support a **considered judgement**
about their position on a **scale** of competence
from less expert to more expert
representing what they know and can do
and what they need to learn next
with a **sufficient** degree of confidence
to support them in their learning
and to provide recognition of their attainment
that people can **trust**

- Enterprise Professor S. Milligan

THE UNIVERSITY OF MELBOURNE

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THE AMBITION

TRANSFORMING WHAT WE VALUE IN SCHOOLS

Current metrics in schooling favour narrow definitions of learning success, shaped by the industrial model, the old 'grammar of schooling', that are no longer sufficient in a modern education.

—

A new 'grammar of schooling' empowers young people to be producers of their own learning and supports them to develop the human competencies required to thrive in a world of great technological advancement, where they face global challenges and opportunities, and a range of unknown career options.

Leading schools and school systems recognise that a broader range of metrics is required to support learners, teachers and school leaders to develop, assess and recognise the complex competencies young people need today.

The University of Melbourne has generated reliable and robust resources to support educational settings that have a strategic interest in:

- student agency in learning;
- advancing the way complex competencies are taught, assessed and reported on;
- credentialing learners at key transition points of schooling;
- engaging in professional learning to build staff capacity to lead new assessment practices;
- equipping students with sophisticated learning skills;
- contributing to the growing evidence-base for systemic change;
- using next-generation assessment and recognition approaches to leverage the transformation they wish to achieve.

Competency education is not an 'add on' to the existing features of schooling, rather an opportunity to learn knowledge and skills through developing and exercising competence in areas of interest.

Moving towards the new grammar of schooling is an opportunity to rethink the emphasis on standardisation in current practices and embrace the complexity of a more sophisticated student-centred approach to learning.

OLD GRAMMAR → NEW GRAMMAR

Features of the old grammar are familiar to educators and help hold the industrial model of schooling in place (e.g., learning and success defined by age/stage, teacher solely as content expert, standardised examinations, timetabled blocks of learning).

Educators leading transformation consider the shifts required to move from the old grammar to the new. Below is a micro-level example of the kinds of shifts required in learning and teaching.

OLD GRAMMAR FOCUS

Students **use feedback** to learn from mistakes and use teacher advice.

NEW GRAMMAR FOCUS

Students **generate feedback loops** to seek, use and give feedback to enhance performance, learning skills, learning partnerships and autonomy.

THE AMBITION

WHY COMPLEX COMPETENCIES?

A shift to the new grammar of schooling with a commitment to the development of complex competencies makes it imperative that students develop agency in learning.

Complex competencies might also be referred to as '21st Century skills'; 'soft skills'; 'general capabilities'; 'transferable skills', 'graduate attributes', 'approaches to learning', or similar. Despite the differences in name, all cover similar skills, attitudes and values that learners are expected to develop to thrive at school and in the future.

A complex competency is:

- teachable, learnable, observable, assessable;
- learned in the context of developing expertise in particular domains;
- developed inside and outside formal education;
- transferable across contexts, that is, competencies learned in one context or place that can be transferred to another*.

Agency in Learning is essential to the new grammar of schooling. This competency is considered fundamental to the development of all competencies.

AGENCY IN LEARNING

The capacity to produce learning of value to self or community

ACTING ETHICALLY

Acting in a way that is guided by moral principles (what we ought to do) in any situation

ACTIVE CITIZENSHIP

Contributing to the well-being of a community

COMMUNICATION

The ability to transmit, receive and interpret information, ideas, arguments, feelings and beliefs to support the purposes of the individual or group

COLLABORATION

Working with others to achieve a common goal

QUALITY THINKING

Thinking things through to achieve better outcomes for yourself or your group

PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

The ability to live by the attitudes and behaviours that your communities value

FOR LEADERS

CONDITIONS THAT SUPPORT A TRANSFORMATIVE AGENDA

School leaders are in a position to optimise the conditions for teaching and learning of the complex competencies young people need in a modern education.

Transforming the 'grammar of schooling' takes bold, nurturing and influential leadership. Experienced transformative leaders describe these actions as levers for change.

LEADERS DO THIS...	SO THAT TEACHERS...	SO THAT LEARNERS CAN...
Champion learning ambitions that prepare learners for their life at school and beyond	Feel compelled and empowered to align their learning design and assessment practices	Feel empowered to learn according to their ambitions and interests
Privilege competencies as a focus of learning at the school	Design learning that includes a focus on learner competence	Have the opportunity to develop, exercise and demonstrate competence
Build a culture that values learner agency	Can be co-designers, coaches and facilitators of learning	Be empowered and responsible for their own learning and the learning of others
Consider the organisation of learning to prioritise relationships	Have the time and opportunity to work in depth with learners; to respond to their specific learning needs	Be truly known by their educators
Allow time and space for deep professional collaboration	Learn and work with colleagues from different ages, stages, learning areas, networks	Learn in transdisciplinary and multi-aged settings
Generate community interest and trust in the importance of competency education	Can work in partnership with students and families to develop learner competence	Be supported and recognised for what they know and can do, broadly defined, within and beyond the school
Prioritise next-gen assessment design	Can rethink the purpose of assessment	Know they are being recognised for a broad range of what they know and can do

A NOTE ON SCHOOL ASSESSMENT PRACTICES

It is important not to over-assess.

Complex competencies develop over time and with multiple exposures to opportunities to develop and exercise competence. They do not need to be measured at the beginning, middle and end of a unit of learning. It is recommended that teachers use the University's online assessment platform Ruby to assess a student in a particular competence no more than once or twice per year.

Unlike the attainment of domain-based knowledge or skills (e.g., in History or Maths), competence cannot be developed via direct instruction alone. Rather it is developed across a variety of occasions and contexts (e.g., collaboration can be developed in a Science class, a school musical, a group multi-domain inquiry project, etc).

School leaders align desired conditions for competence development with assessment protocols and schedules.

FOR LEADERS

USING NEXT-GENERATION RECOGNITION

Reporting and credentialing systems reflect what is valued in learning and can serve a variety of purposes for students, teachers and external stakeholders.

PURPOSE 1: PLANNING

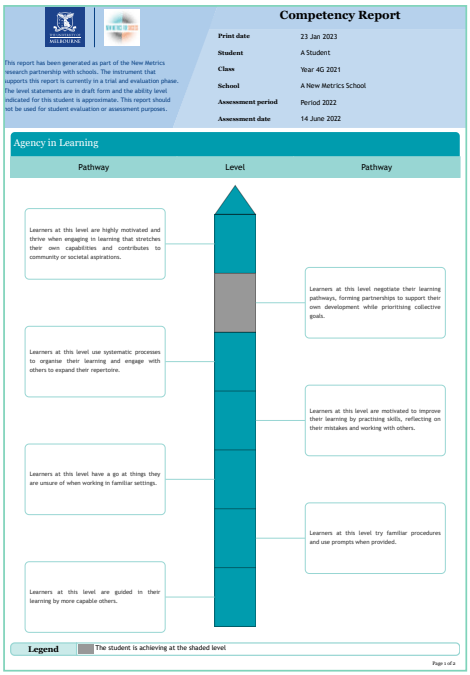
Teachers can use the University's online assessment platform, Ruby, to generate rocket reports for individual assessments of learners. These are useful for:

- planning 'next steps' for learners;
- informing learning design decisions;
- team discussions about learners and classes;
- reflection for teachers and learners.

Teacher planning also benefits from insights gained when learners share reflections on their own competence.

This serves the dual purpose of developing learner understanding of the competence (and why it is of value) and supporting teachers to plan for an individual learner's next steps.

A sample learner reflection tool is provided on p21. Before using such a tool, teachers should ensure learners understand the competence and its definition (through class discussions, sharing examples, etc) and how their reflections will be used to support their development.



This report has been generated as part of the New Metrics research partnership with schools. The instrument that supports this report is currently in a trial and evaluation phase. The level statements are in draft form and the ability level indicated for this student is approximate. This report should not be used for student evaluation or assessment purposes.

Competency Report

Print date	23 Jan 2023
Student	A Student
Class	Year 4G 2021
School	A New Metrics School
Assessment period	Period 2022
Assessment date	14 June 2022

Agency in Learning

Pathway | Level | Pathway

Learners at this level are highly motivated and thrive when engaging in learning that stretches their own capabilities and contributes to community or societal aspirations.

Learners at this level negotiate their learning pathways, forming partnerships to support their own development while prioritising collective goals.

Learners at this level use systematic processes to organise their learning and engage with others to expand their repertoire.

Learners at this level are motivated to improve their learning by practising skills, reflecting on their mistakes and working with others.

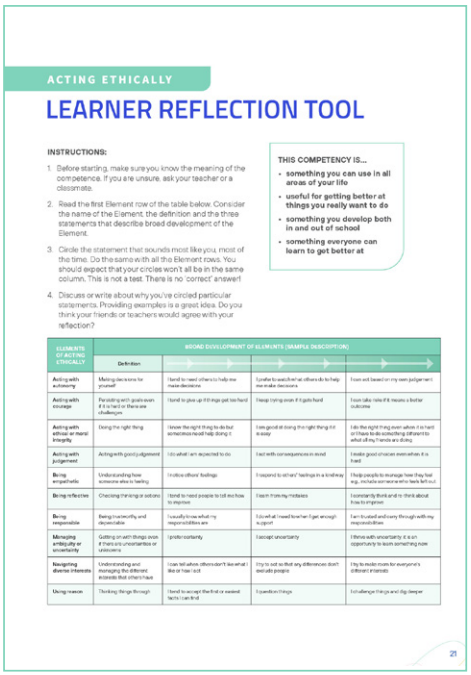
Learners at this level have a go at things they are unsure of when working in familiar settings.

Learners at this level try familiar procedures and use prompts when provided.

Learners at this level are guided in their learning by more capable others.

Legend: The student is achieving at the shaded level

Page 1 of 2



ACTING ETHICALLY

LEARNER REFLECTION TOOL

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Before starting, make sure you know the meaning of the competence. If you are unsure, ask your teacher or a classmate.
2. Read the first Element row of the table below. Consider the name of the Element, the definition and the three statements that describe broad development of the Element.
3. Circle the statement that sounds most like you, most of the time. Do the same with all the Element rows. You should expect that your circles won't all be in the same column. This is not a test. There is no 'correct' answer!
4. Discuss or write about why you've circled particular statements. Providing examples is a great idea. Do you think your friends or teachers would agree with your reflection?

THIS COMPETENCY IS...

- something you can use in all areas of your life
- useful for getting better at things you really want to do
- something you develop both in and out of school
- something everyone can learn to get better at

ELEMENTS OF ACTING ETHICALLY	BROAD DEVELOPMENT OF ELEMENTS (SAMPLE DESCRIPTION)			
	Definition			
Acting with autonomy	Making decisions for yourself	I tend to need others to help me make decisions	I prefer to watch what others do to help me make decisions	I can act based on my own judgement
Acting with courage	Persisting with goals even if it is hard or there are challenges	I tend to give up if things get too hard	I keep trying even if it gets hard	I can take risks if it means a better outcome
Acting with ethical or moral integrity	Doing the right thing	I know the right thing to do but sometimes need help doing it	I am good at doing the right thing if it is easy	I do the right thing even when it is hard or I have to do something different to what all my friends are doing
Acting with judgement	Acting with good judgement	I do what I am expected to do	I act with consequences in mind	I make good choices even when it is hard
Being empathetic	Understanding how someone else is feeling	I notice others' feelings	I respond to others' feelings in a kind way	I help people to manage how they feel e.g. include someone who feels left out
Being reflective	Checking thinking or actions	I tend to need people to tell me how to improve	I learn from my mistakes	I constantly think and re-think about how to improve
Being responsible	Being trustworthy and dependable	I usually know what my responsibilities are	I do what I need to when I get enough support	I am trusted and carry through with my responsibilities
Managing ambiguity or uncertainty	Getting on with things even if there are uncertainties or unknowns	I prefer certainty	I accept uncertainty	I thrive with uncertainty: it is an opportunity to learn something new
Navigating diverse interests	Understanding and managing the different interests that others have	I can tell when others don't like what I like or how I act	I try to act so that any differences don't overrate people	I try to make room for everyone's different interests
Using reason	Thinking things through	I tend to accept the first or easiest facts I can find	I question things	I challenge things and dig deeper

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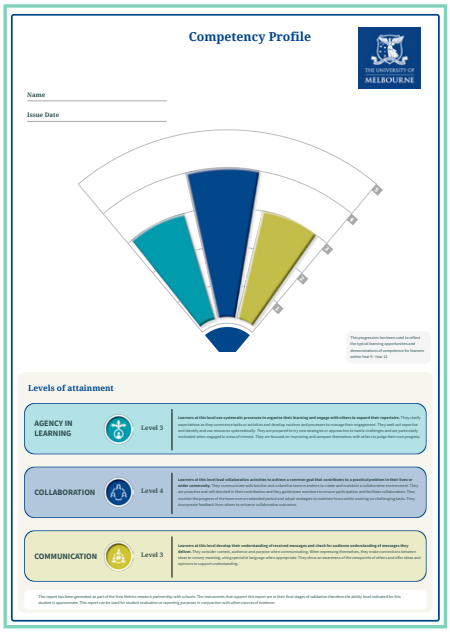
PURPOSE 2: SCHOOL REPORTING

Fan Profiles represent aggregated assessments for each competency, for multiple competencies. These are useful for:

- yearly or semesterly reporting to learners and families;
- professional discussions about learners and learning design.

Learner fan profiles can be generated each semester if the following requirements are met:

- A minimum of two competencies must be assessed;
- For each competency, a minimum of two valid assessments must be completed.



PURPOSE 3: CREDENTIALING

The Learner Competency Credential is issued to learners at key transition points in their education: primary to secondary; entry into senior secondary; end of senior secondary.

It captures aggregated assessments over time and recognises levels of learner attainment that are supported by robust moderation processes. It is formally warranted by The University of Melbourne.

Learners receive printable and digital credentials that have broad utility beyond their school for:

- transition from one educational setting to another (e.g., primary to secondary);
- admissions processes (e.g., tertiary entrance);
- internal qualifications (e.g., a Middle Years certificate);
- Employment.

Credentials can be generated at end of year if assessment and moderation requirements are met. Schools intending to generate credentials will work directly with the University team to understand these requirements and engage in a University-led school assessment audit.

Image: The Australian Learner Competency Credential

FOR LEADERS

RUBY

Ruby is the University's platform that schools use to conduct formal assessments and generate reports and credentials.

WHAT DOES RUBY DO?

Ruby invites teachers to check their judgements by answering a series of multiple-choice style questions about typical behavioural indicators of the competence being assessed. It uses teacher judgement to locate a learner on a standards-based learning progression and generates learner reports.

HOW DOES RUBY WORK?

Ruby will prompt the user to nominate the purpose of the assessment i.e. teachers choose whether the assessment is for teacher planning, or for school reporting or credentialing.

Depending on the age / stage of learning, and the purpose of the assessment and reporting, Ruby will ask fewer or greater number of questions. For example, an assessment conducted for the purposes of teacher planning may have approx. 10 questions, whereas an assessment contributing towards a credential may have approx. 22 questions.

WHAT REPORTS ARE GENERATED?

Regardless of the assessment purpose, all teacher assessments will auto-generate a rocket report. This includes teacher assessments that will contribute towards a learner fan profile or a credential.

TEACHERS MAKE MICRO-JUDGEMENTS BY RESPONDING TO QUESTIONS ABOUT A LEARNER.

Questions in Ruby aim to bring to the surface indicative behaviours of competence across a range of ages, stages and contexts.

The example provided here shows a model of the language and the broad steps of progression teachers will select from when recording their judgements in Ruby.

When interacting with classmates and others, does the learner:

- **acknowledge the rights of others to express themselves and be treated fairly**
- **avoid infringing on others' rights, such as interrupting or dismissing their opinions**
- **support others in exercising their rights, offering assistance when needed**
- **advocate for the protection and respect of individual rights within the school community**

FOR TEACHERS

HOW TO SUPPORT LEARNERS TO DEVELOP COMPETENCE

STEP 1.

FAMILIARISE YOURSELF with the competency. Use the following to strengthen a common understanding of the competency between teachers:

- competency definition (p13)
- age/stage appropriate learning progressions (p14 – 16)

In addition, it can be helpful to understand the composition of the competency

- elements of the competence (p17)
- broad development of elements (p18)

STEP 2.

CONSIDER LEARNING DESIGN that provides opportunity for students to learn, exercise and demonstrate competence.

- Does it provide you with opportunity to observe evidence of learners' competence over time?
- Does it allow you to privilege learner agency in the development of competence?
- How can the competency be developed across multiple contexts in connection with other goals (e.g., developing competence whilst also attaining knowledge)?
- Do you have the opportunity to truly know each student as a learner?

Teachers can use the teaching for competence table on p12 to examine the conditions they provide to learners to exercise competence and activate their agency in learning.

Importantly, to demonstrate more advanced levels of competence (i.e., Levels 4 and 5 in the learning progression) students must be provided with conditions that activate their agency as learners and go beyond direct instruction or scaffolded teaching.

STEP 3.

ASSESS & REPORT. Assessment must have a purpose. Determine the purpose of your assessment and have adequate evidence to support your judgement.

Refer to p8 & p9 to review reporting and credentialing options.

FOR TEACHERS

TEACHING FOR COMPETENCE

Great teaching draws from a rich repertoire, using different approaches for a variety of purposes and learners. There are times when direct instruction is the most appropriate activity. There are also times teachers can be mentors that support learner agency through the conditions they provide. This table highlights features to be considered when providing students the opportunity to learn, exercise and demonstrate competence.

Considerations for learning design and opportunity for agency	Purpose	Evidence of learning	Openness of process	Supervision	Scope of discipline knowledge and skill required	Authenticity	Scale	Connection to others
TEACHER AS MENTOR	Focuses on solving or participating in the solution of a practical problem for which the solution is unknown (i.e. goes beyond mastery of knowledge to application) Contributes to something of interest in their lives or community.	Learner curates and designs evidence used to demonstrate skill (e.g., portfolio) Evidence sourced inside and outside of school	The process is open and challenging, with little guidance provided by the teacher Allows for learners to conceptualise, construct, organise, analyse and test their own process, and make their own mistakes	Learner mentored and advised on request	Learners need to be self-directed and collaborate to master new and deeper knowledge and skill	Replicates real world experiences, or is a real-world experience Outcome has significance beyond the classroom	Requires long term (e.g., a semester) commitment and allows for flexible application Allows revisiting, reflection and reconceptualization of ideas and mistakes with opportunity for immersion	Learners independently build connections with new people and places outside of school
SCAFFOLDED TEACHING	Shaped, but not defined, by a learner's interests Includes choices within product or process	Learners negotiate how they will evidence their learning (e.g., product)	Process is defined with scope for interpretation and variation by the learner	Learner's work is supervised Provided with guidance, examples, modelling,	Requires application and exploration of knowledge or skill in the related domain that goes beyond what the learner already knows and can do Requires learner initiative to develop required knowledge or skill	Is relevant to the learners' immediate lives outside of the classroom	Scope for demonstrating depth and commitment (e.g., a five-week unit of work)	Learners independently connect with familiar people and places outside the classroom, (e.g., grandparents, neighbours)
DIRECTED INSTRUCTION	Goals, product, process, content determined by the teacher Context selected by the teacher so it is likely to appeal to learners	Learners use provided templates to demonstrate learning (e.g., worksheet, template for a project)	Learner provided with familiar steps to follow	The learner is directed and supervised	Requires knowledge or skill that is mostly already known to the learner	Designed for classroom learning	Short, fixed duration (e.g., a focus for a few days) time limited, timetabled	Involves familiar school-based people Connection with external others is planned and facilitate by the school

ACTING ETHICALLY

Acting in a way that is guided by moral principles (what we ought to do) in any situation

LEARNING PROGRESSIONS

Assessors can recognise a learner's competence on a continuum of development known as a learning progression.

The following learning progressions take into account a broad range of ages/stages of development. They represent the qualitative leaps in development of competence; reflecting the growth in sophistication of application of competence that arises as learners develop in age and throughout typical stages of schooling.

The progressions can be used to:

- develop teacher and learner understanding of growth in the competence;
- report on learner attainment and growth.

Competence is hierarchical and those at higher levels can and should still use the things they learned at lower levels to operate expertly in different contexts. Being at a higher level means one has at their disposal a wider and deeper repertoire to deploy as required.

The developmental levels are broad, as capacity to perform at a level derives from a complex amalgam of skills, knowledge, attitudes and values. No two individuals operating at the same level will act in the same way, as there are different ways to express their capabilities.

KINDERGARTEN – YEAR 4

Level		Level Statement
5	THE ETHICAL ACTIVIST	**Learners at this level lead and mobilise others to take action based on their understanding of core ethical issues.** They form their own views on what is the right thing to do in circumstances with which they are familiar. On this basis, they raise awareness or voice their individual opinion even if others don't agree. They use their view of what is right to consider the impacts on everyone involved and explore the pros and cons of taking action.
4	THE EMPATHETIC ETHICAL DECISION MAKER	**Learners at this level are committed to understanding the perspectives and needs of others in order to make fair and just decisions.** They are beginning to understand the importance of ethical decision-making and the impact their actions can have on others. They seek out different perspectives and values when considering a decision and strive for fairness and equity. They use reasoning and evidence to support their own opinions and are not afraid to respectfully question alternative views. With a growing sense of empathy and compassion, they are conscious of the consequences of their actions and work to defend those who may be marginalised or disadvantaged.
3	THE ETHICAL NAVIGATOR	**Learners at this level use their own moral compass to navigate ethical situations. They are developing their own values and beliefs.** They understand the importance of using these values as a foundation for making ethical decisions. They are curious about different perspectives and are open to changing their views when presented with new information or reasoning. They have a strong sense of what is right and wrong and are willing to speak up for their beliefs. They have a growing awareness of the consequences of their actions and strive to make decisions that are fair and equitable to all involved, including their community and personal connections. They prioritise the well-being of those they care about.
2	THE ETHICAL EXPLORER	**Learners at this level are developing their ethical understanding and decision-making skills.** They are starting to understand the concept of ethics and exploring how different beliefs and values play a role in decision making. They are learning to consider the perspectives of others and are beginning to take steps towards making a positive impact in their community. They may rely on their own experiences and the experiences of people they know when forming opinions and taking action, but they are open to learning and considering different viewpoints. They are starting to develop their own moral beliefs and are taking steps towards making informed and responsible decisions.
1	THE ETHICAL CONFORMIST	**Learners at this level rely on the values and opinions of familiar others, such as authority figures and peers, to guide their ethical views and actions.** They are in the early stages of understanding and engaging with ethical issues. They are in the early stages of understanding of the reasoning behind ethical ideas and can act impulsively based on their emotions and limited experience. They are open to discussing ethical ideas with trusted adults and peers but need guidance and support to understand and work through ethical issues. They tend to focus on the impact of ethical issues on themselves rather than considering a broader perspective and the impact on others.

YEAR 5 – YEAR 8

Level		Level Statement
5	THE ETHICAL ACTIVIST	**Learners at this level lead and mobilise others to take action based on their understanding of core ethical issues.** They form their own views on what is the right thing to do in familiar and unfamiliar contexts. On this basis, they raise awareness or voice their individual opinion, even if others don't agree. They use their view of what is right to consider the impacts on everyone involved and explore the pros and cons of taking action.
4	THE EMPATHETIC ETHICAL DECISION MAKER	**Learners at this level are committed to understanding the perspectives and needs of others in order to make fair and just decisions.** They demonstrate a strong sense of social and ethical responsibility. They are aware of the complexities of different moral and ethical issues and approach their decision-making process thoughtfully. They use reason and evidence to support their own opinions and engage in respectful debate when different views arise. They understand the impact of their actions on all parties involved and act with compassion and empathy towards those who may be marginalized or disadvantaged.
3	THE ETHICAL NAVIGATOR	**Learners at this level use their own moral compass to navigate ethical situations.** They use their own values and beliefs as a guide for making ethical decisions. They are willing to consider different perspectives and adjust their views when faced with new information or reasoning. They speak out and stand up for what they believe is right, even if it is contrary to popular opinion or social norms. They consider the impact of their actions on all parties involved, including their community and personal connections, and work towards making fair and equitable decisions. They prioritise the well-being of those to whom they are connected.
2	THE ETHICAL EXPLORER	**Learners at this level are developing their ethical understanding and decision-making skills.** They are starting to take an active role in exploring and addressing ethical issues. They understand that different people and communities have varying perspectives on what is right and wrong and are open to considering different ideas and opinions. They ask for advice from others, while also relying on their own experiences and those of people they know when forming ethical opinions and taking action. Although they may prioritise their own experiences, previous beliefs and dominant views, they are also open to changing their views when faced with new information or reasoning.
1	THE ETHICAL CONFORMIST	**Learners at this level rely on the values and opinions of familiar others, such as authority figures and peers, to guide their ethical views and actions.** They are learning to explore and understand the reasoning behind various ethical ideas. They may act impulsively, without fully considering the consequences of their actions. They are open to discussing ethical issues with those they trust, such as familiar adults and peers. They may require guidance or direction when attempting to solve ethical issues and tend to prioritise the personal impact of ethical dilemmas, rather than considering the broader societal implications.

YEAR 9 – YEAR 12

Level		Level Statement
5	THE ETHICAL ACTIVIST	**Learners at this level lead and mobilise others to take action based on their understanding of core ethical issues.** They seek out information and engage in critical analysis to understand complex ethical issues and make informed decisions. They recognise the impact of their actions on individuals and communities and strive to create a positive and just society. They are prepared to challenge harmful systems or practices and take risks to bring about meaningful change. They foster a culture of empathy and respect and work towards creating a more inclusive and equitable society. They are committed to ongoing personal and collective growth and engage in ongoing learning and reflection to deepen their understanding and effectiveness as ethical activists.
4	THE EMPATHETIC ETHICAL DECISION MAKER	**Learners at this level are committed to understanding the perspectives and needs of others in order to make fair and just decisions.** They actively seek out and consider multiple perspectives and values when making ethical decisions and are concerned with equity and fairness. They use evidence and reason to support their own opinions and are willing to respectfully challenge alternative views when necessary. They are aware of the consequences of their actions for all parties involved, and act with compassion and empathy to help and defend those who may be marginalised or disadvantaged.
3	THE ETHICAL NAVIGATOR	**Learners at this level use their own moral compass to navigate ethical situations.** They are aware of their own values and beliefs and use them as a foundation for making ethical decisions. They actively seek out different perspectives and are open to changing their views when presented with new information or reasoning. They are willing to speak out and advocate what they believe is right, even if it goes against the norm or popular opinion. They consider the impact of their actions on all parties involved and strive to make fair and equitable decisions. They prioritise the well-being of their immediate community and those they have personal connections with.
2	THE ETHICAL EXPLORER	**Learners at this level are developing their ethical understanding and decision-making skills.** They are starting to engage with ethical issues and are beginning to explore different perspectives and ideas, while also taking individual and collective action to address ethical issues within their own community. They are open to considering alternative views and seeking advice from others, while also relying on their own experiences and those of people they know when forming opinions and taking action. They tend to prioritize their own experiences, previous beliefs and dominant views when offering their opinions and solutions on ethical issues.
1	THE ETHICAL CONFORMIST	**Learners at this level rely on the values and opinions of familiar others, such as authority figures and peers, to guide their ethical views and actions.** They may adopt ethical ideas without fully considering the reasoning behind them and tend to act impulsively. They are willing to discuss ethical ideas with familiar adults and peers and may require guidance or direction when working on solutions to ethical issues. They tend to focus on the impact of ethical issues on themselves rather than considering the broader perspective.

ELEMENTS OF COMPETENCE

The University of Melbourne's assessment architecture includes foundational elements of competence.

Each complex competency is a combination of foundational elements of competence, wherein the whole (competency) is greater than the sum of its parts (elements).

When designing learning, teachers should primarily provide opportunity for the competence to be exercised and observed, rather than, for example, planning lessons that align with each element.

One might consider the elements as puzzle pieces or building blocks of the competence, or as vital organs that make a living thing.

Understanding these elements can be helpful in forming teachers conception of the competence, for inspiring learning design, and for tuning into the evidence of competence development.

The Elements (the 'building blocks' of competence)

The University's assessment architecture, including the learning progressions and elements, provides a 'currency' of competency assessment which can be used to assess a broad range of competencies.

This underpinning, standards-based assessment architecture allows students who are learning in different contexts, curricula and learning designs to be assessed and recognised in a robust and comparable way.

ELEMENTS OF

ACTING ETHICALLY

Definition: Acting in a way that is guided by moral principles (what we ought to do) in any situation

DEFINITION:

ACTING WITH AUTONOMY

—

The ability to govern one's own actions

DEFINITION:

ACTING WITH COURAGE

—

The ability to act in the pursuit of a worthwhile goal in the face of adversity

DEFINITION:

ACTING WITH ETHICAL OR MORAL INTEGRITY

—

The ability to uphold ethical or moral principles and do the right thing

DEFINITION:

ACTING WITH JUDGEMENT

—

The ability to act on the basis of sound assessments, evaluations or decisions

DEFINITION:

BEING EMPATHETIC

—

The ability to be sensitive to another person's feelings or states of mind

DEFINITION:

BEING REFLECTIVE

—

The ability to evaluate and learn from experience

DEFINITION:

BEING RESPONSIBLE

—

The ability to deliver reliably on commitments

DEFINITION:

MANAGING AMBIGUITY OR UNCERTAINTY

—

The ability to operate in the face of things that are unknown, uncertain, or undecidable

DEFINITION:

NAVIGATING DIVERSE INTERESTS

—

The ability to manage diverse or conflicting interests, needs, customs, or values

DEFINITION:

USING REASON

—

The ability to use thinking skills to explain, argue, analyse or evaluate

UNDERSTANDING THE ELEMENTS OF COMPETENCE

It can be helpful to understand what broad development in the foundational elements of a competency looks like. This supports teachers to align their learning and assessment design.

It is important to remember that the synergy of the elements is what makes a complex competency. For example, whilst focusing on the development of a single element will indeed contribute to a learner's qualities, having a view to the marked leaps of development of the complex competence as a whole (the progressions) is crucial.

ELEMENTS OF ACTING ETHICALLY	BROAD DEVELOPMENT OF ELEMENTS (SAMPLE DESCRIPTION)			
	Definition			
Acting with autonomy	The ability to govern one's own actions	Actions are governed by rules, conventions, or other people	Actions are influenced but not determined by external influences	Acts according to own judgement, values, or objectives
Acting with courage	The ability to act in the pursuit of a worthwhile goal in the face of adversity	Recognises when courage or risk is needed	Acts even if it means feeling uncomfortable	Acts in the face of likely negative consequences
Acting with ethical or moral integrity	The ability to uphold ethical or moral principles and do the right thing	Recognises and understands what is right	Acts in the right way when the temptation to do otherwise is not strong	Does the right thing in the face of conflicting pressures or strong temptation to do otherwise
Acting with judgement	The ability to act on the basis of sound assessments, evaluations or decisions	Acts on custom, rules, expectations or habit	Acts on the basis of consideration	Acts in a shrewd, practical, wise or discerning manner
Being empathetic	The ability to be sensitive to another person's feelings or states of mind	Notices others' feelings or states of mind	Responds with understanding to others' feelings or states of mind	Engages with others' feelings or states of mind to help them learn or grow
Being reflective	The ability to evaluate and learn from experience	Thinks about actions or experiences	Evaluates thinking or action when outcomes do not match expectations	Takes lessons from all experiences and reflects to improve
Being responsible	The ability to deliver reliably on commitments	Recognises responsibilities	Delivers with encouragement	Delivers reliably; is trusted to deliver
Managing ambiguity or uncertainty	The ability to operate in the face of things that are unknown, uncertain, or undecidable	Acknowledges uncertainty	Accepts uncertainty or undecidability	Treats uncertainty or undecidability as opportunity to explore alternative possibilities
Navigating diverse interests	The ability to manage diverse or conflicting interests, needs, customs, or values	Acknowledges diversity	Accommodates diversity	Capitalises on diversity
Using reason	The ability to use thinking skills to explain, argue, analyse or evaluate	Bases thinking on specific examples or personal experience	Applies general principles or abstract concepts	Displays scepticism: questions assumptions, identifies biases, evaluates evidence, critiques arguments

LEARNER REFLECTION TOOL

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Before starting, make sure you know the meaning of the competence. If you are unsure, ask your teacher or a classmate.
2. Read the first Element row of the table below. Consider the name of the Element, the definition and the three statements that describe broad development of the Element.
3. Circle the statement that sounds most like you, most of the time. Do the same with all the Element rows. You should expect that your circles won't all be in the same column. This is not a test. There is no 'correct' answer!
4. Discuss or write about why you've circled particular statements. Providing examples is a great idea. Do you think your friends or teachers would agree with your reflection?

THIS COMPETENCY IS...

- **something you can use in all areas of your life**
- **useful for getting better at things you really want to do**
- **something you develop both in and out of school**
- **something everyone can learn to get better at**

ELEMENTS OF ACTING ETHICALLY	BROAD DEVELOPMENT OF ELEMENTS (SAMPLE DESCRIPTION)			
	Definition			
Acting with autonomy	Making decisions for yourself	I tend to need others to help me make decisions	I prefer to watch what others do to help me make decisions	I can act based on my own judgement
Acting with courage	Persisting with goals even if it is hard or there are challenges	I tend to give up if things get too hard	I keep trying even if it gets hard	I can take risks if it means a better outcome
Acting with ethical or moral integrity	Doing the right thing	I know the right thing to do but sometimes need help doing it	I am good at doing the right thing if it is easy	I do the right thing even when it is hard or I have to do something different to what all my friends are doing
Acting with judgement	Acting with good judgement	I do what I am expected to do	I act with consequences in mind	I make good choices even when it is hard
Being empathetic	Understanding how someone else is feeling	I notice others' feelings	I respond to others' feelings in a kind way	I help people to manage how they feel e.g., include someone who feels left out
Being reflective	Checking thinking or actions	I tend to need people to tell me how to improve	I learn from my mistakes	I constantly think and re-think about how to improve
Being responsible	Being trustworthy and dependable	I usually know what my responsibilities are	I do what I need to when I get enough support	I am trusted and carry through with my responsibilities
Managing ambiguity or uncertainty	Getting on with things even if there are uncertainties or unknowns	I prefer certainty	I accept uncertainty	I thrive with uncertainty, it is an opportunity to learn something new
Navigating diverse interests	Understanding and managing the different interests that others have	I can tell when others don't like what I like or how I act	I try to act so that any differences don't exclude people	I try to make room for everyone's different interests
Using reason	Thinking things through	I tend to accept the first or easiest facts I can find	I question things	I challenge things and dig deeper

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